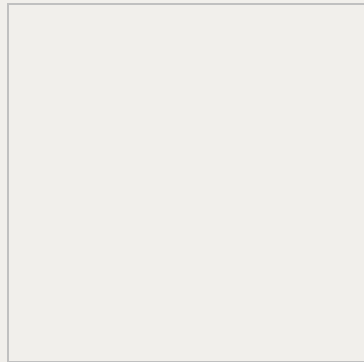


ON TECHNIQUE

Lutheran church music

Music was an integral element of Lutheran church services. By the 18th century, the singing of chorales (hymns) by the congregation was accompanied and harmonized by an organist, who might provide solo preludes and interludes. Cantatas—more elaborate performances by solo singers, choir, and instrumentalists—were also integrated into the service. The musical element of a service might last an hour or more. Sunday services were the main musical performances available in German cities, although some Lutherans felt that music distracted from worship.



GERMAN BAROQUE
ORGAN MADE IN
THURINGIA IN AROUND
1650

The last of eight children, Johann Sebastian Bach was born in the town of Eisenach in Thuringia, Germany, in March 1685. Members of his family had been musicians since the 16th